Caboodle

Centralizing Design Asset Distribution for Amazon Customer Service

A UX Case Study by Pradeep | Sr. Visual Designer

> **[VISUAL: Hero Banner]** Full-width hero showcasing the Caboodle platform UI — the redesigned home page with team navigation and asset cards visible. Dark or branded background with project title, role, and key stat overlay ("5,200+ users").

Introduction

Overview of the Project

Caboodle is a centralized design asset management platform built for Amazon Customer Service teams. It serves as a single source of truth for design templates, logos, banners, email templates, and other visual assets — replacing a fragmented system of shared drives, folders, and ticket-based support workflows. The project involved a complete UX overhaul of an existing but neglected platform, transforming it from a rigid, poorly organized repository into an intuitive, self-service design ecosystem.

Project Name & Client

Project: Caboodle

Organization: Amazon Customer Service — Design Team

Role & Responsibilities

I served as the **lead UX Designer** responsible for the platform's redesign and UX strategy. My role encompassed user research (interviews and surveys with 100-150 stakeholders), information architecture redesign, navigation design, UI design, prototyping, A/B testing, and iterative refinement. I transformed an existing but unmaintained platform into a user-centered design asset hub.

> **[VISUAL: Project Snapshot Card]** Summary card:
>
> - **Role:** Lead UX Designer
> - **Duration:** [Timeline]
> - **Tools:** Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator
> - **Methods:** User Interviews (100-150 participants), Surveys, A/B Testing
> - **Impact:** 550% user growth | Downloads 36% → 81%

Problem Statement

What Problem Are We Solving?

Before Caboodle's redesign, the design team's asset distribution workflow was chaotic, scattered, and unsustainable. Teams across Amazon Customer Service needed regular access to design assets — templates, logos, banners, email layouts — but the system for accessing these assets was broken at every level.

> **[VISUAL: Problem Ecosystem Diagram]** Illustration showing the "chaos state" — multiple disconnected systems:
>
> - Shared Drive A
> - Shared Drive B
> - Email threads
> - Ticket system

> - Slack messages All with dotted lines and question marks showing disconnection. Center label: "No Single Source of Truth"

Business & User Challenges

Business Challenges:

- Design team spent excessive time on repetitive support tickets for asset requests
- No scalable system to distribute assets across growing number of teams
- Duplicate and outdated assets circulating across multiple shared drives
- Unable to track usage, adoption, or asset performance
- Team resources consumed by manual distribution rather than creative work

User Challenges:

- Assets were scattered across multiple folder locations in shared drives
- No centralized navigation or discovery mechanism
- Finding the right template required knowing the exact folder path
- No logical organization — templates from different teams were mixed together
- Workflow was rigid and lengthy — users often needed to submit tickets for basic asset access
- The existing platform (before redesign) had no UX consideration, no information architecture, and no clear navigation

Goals & Objectives

> **[VISUAL: Project Goals — Numbered Badges]** Six circular badges arranged in two rows, each with a number and goal title:
>
> 1. Centralize assets
> 2. Enable self-service
> 3. Redesign IA
> 4. Add navigation
> 5. Increase adoption
> 6. Reduce support burden

1. Create a single, centralized platform for all design asset distribution
2. Eliminate the need for ticket-based asset requests where possible
3. Design an intuitive information architecture that organizes assets by team
4. Provide clear navigation that enables self-service discovery
5. Increase adoption across all CS teams
6. Reduce design team's support burden

Research & Discovery

User Research

> **[VISUAL: Research Scale Infographic]** Large-number callouts:
>
> - **100-150** stakeholders interviewed
> - **Team Managers + Operations Managers** participant pool
> - **2 Methods:** Interviews + Surveys Include participant silhouettes or avatar grid showing the scale of research.

User Interviews (100-150 Participants): I conducted extensive interviews with Team Managers and Operations Managers across Amazon Customer Service. This large sample size was intentional — with dozens of teams relying on design assets, we needed to understand the breadth of pain points across different user groups. Interviews revealed:

- Teams had developed their own workarounds (personal bookmarks, team-specific folders, Slack channels for sharing)

- Many users didn't know certain assets existed because they had no way to discover them
- The ticket-based request system created bottlenecks — simple requests took days
- Users wanted independence in finding and downloading assets without design team intervention

User Surveys: Surveys quantified the scale of the problem and helped prioritize which teams and asset types needed attention first. They confirmed that the scattered folder system was a universal pain point, not limited to specific teams.

> **[VISUAL: Research Findings — Affinity Map]** Digital affinity map (or photo of physical one) showing clustered themes:
> - Cluster 1: "Can't find assets" (6-8 sticky notes)
> - Cluster 2: "Too many places to look" (5-7 sticky notes)
> - Cluster 3: "Want self-service" (4-6 sticky notes)
> - Cluster 4: "Version confusion" (3-5 sticky notes) Color-coded by severity/frequency.

Key Insights & Findings

> **[VISUAL: Insight Cards — 5 Key Findings]** Five insight cards with severity indicators (High/Critical): Each card: Bold Insight Title + One-line supporting evidence

1. **Discoverability was zero** — Users could only find assets they already knew existed and already knew the location of
2. **Team identity was the primary mental model** — Users thought about assets in terms of "my team's stuff" not "all design assets"
3. **Self-service was the overwhelming preference** — Users would rather find assets themselves than submit tickets
4. **Navigation was non-existent** — The old platform was essentially a dumping ground with a UI layer on top
5. **Template freshness mattered** — Users needed confidence they were using the latest version

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User Personas & Empathy Mapping

Target Users & Their Needs

> **[VISUAL: Persona Cards — Three Personas]** Three persona cards side-by-side:
>
> **Card 1 — The Team Manager**
> - Avatar illustration
> - "I need my team's templates quickly without submitting a ticket"
> - Frequency: Weekly access
> - Key Need: Team-specific assets
>
> **Card 2 — The Operations Manager**
> - Avatar illustration
> - "I work across teams and need access to multiple asset sets"
> - Frequency: Bi-weekly access
> - Key Need: Cross-team browsing
>
> **Card 3 — The New Team Member**
> - Avatar illustration
> - "I just joined and have no idea where anything is"
> - Frequency: Initial onboarding + sporadic
> - Key Need: Self-explanatory navigation

Primary Persona: The Team Manager

- Manages a specific CS team (e.g., Amazon Customer Service Experience Team)

- Regularly needs branded templates for team communications, presentations, and reports
- Wants quick, independent access to their team's specific assets
- Values organization and knowing they have the latest version

Secondary Persona: The Operations Manager

- Oversees multiple teams and needs access to cross-team assets
- May need assets for senior leadership presentations
- Values breadth of access and the ability to browse across team boundaries

Tertiary Persona: The New Team Member

- Just joined a CS team and needs to find their team's brand assets
- Has no institutional knowledge of where things are stored
- Needs the platform to be self-explanatory

Empathy Maps

> **[VISUAL: Empathy Map — Quadrant Layout]** Four quadrants (Says, Thinks, Does, Feels) populated with:
>
> - **Says:** "Where is the latest email template?" / "I submitted a ticket 3 days ago"
> - **Thinks:** "There must be a better way" / "Am I using the right version?"
> - **Does:** Searches through 5 different folders / Asks colleagues on Slack / Submits tickets
> - **Feels:** Frustrated / Inefficient / Uncertain

Pain Points:

- "I know a template exists but I can't find it anywhere"
- "I submitted a ticket three days ago for a simple logo download"
- "I'm using a version from six months ago because I don't know where the new one is"
- "Every time I need something, I have to ask the design team"

Goals:

- Find and download team-specific assets independently
- Trust that assets are current and approved
- Spend less time searching and more time executing

Motivations:

- Professional presentations that represent their team well
- Efficiency in day-to-day communications
- Self-sufficiency without design team dependency

User Journey & Experience Mapping

Current vs. Ideal User Journey

> **[VISUAL: Journey Map — Before vs. After]**
>
> **Before Journey (8 steps, ~days):** Need Asset → Search Drive A → Not Found → Search Drive B → Not Found → Ask Colleague → No Help → Submit Ticket → Wait 1-3 Days → Receive Asset Emotion line: Starts neutral, trends to frustrated, ends relieved but exhausted Time indicator: "3-5 days"
>
> **After Journey (4 steps, ~seconds):** Need Asset → Open Caboodle → Navigate to Team → Download Emotion line: Starts neutral, trends upward, ends satisfied Time indicator: "Under 2 minutes"

Current Journey (Before Redesign): Need asset → Search through multiple shared drive folders → Can't find it → Ask colleague → Colleague doesn't know either → Submit design support ticket → Wait 1-3 days → Receive asset → Hope it's the latest version

Ideal Journey (Redesigned Caboodle): Need asset → Open Caboodle → Navigate to team section → Browse organized templates → Download current version → Done (under 2 minutes)

User Flow & Task Analysis

> **[VISUAL: Task Flow Diagram]** Linear flow with 4 main nodes: **Discovery** (knows platform exists) → **Navigation** (clear menu) → **Location** (finds asset) → **Download** (one-click) Each node with a checkmark and time indicator underneath.

The critical flow to optimize was: **Discovery → Navigation → Location → Download**. Each step needed to be frictionless:

- **Discovery:** Users know the platform exists and is the go-to source
- **Navigation:** Clear menu structure that maps to their mental model (team-based)
- **Location:** Intuitive categorization within team sections
- **Download:** One-click access to the asset they need

Information Architecture & Wireframing

Information Architecture

> **[VISUAL: Information Architecture – Tree Diagram]** Detailed IA map showing full hierarchy:
>
> ```
> Caboodle Home
>     ├── Amazon Customer Service
>     │   ├── CS Experience Team
>     │   │   ├── Logos
>     │   │   ├── Banners
>     │   │   ├── Email Templates
>     │   │   └── Presentation Templates
>     │   ├── CS Operations Team
>     │   │   ├── Logos
>     │   │   ├── Banners
>     │   │   └── ...
>     │   └── CS Learning & Development
>     │       └── ...
>     ├── [Other Organizations]
>     └── Recently Added
> ```
>
> Clean tree structure with team-level nodes highlighted. Arrow annotation: "Team-First Mental Model"

The IA redesign was the backbone of this project. The existing platform had no meaningful structure – assets were stored without hierarchy, categorization, or logical grouping. The new IA was built on a **team-first hierarchy:**

Structure: Caboodle Home → Organization (e.g., Amazon Customer Service) → Team (e.g., Customer Service Experience Team) → Asset Category (Logos, Banners, Email Templates, etc.)

This structure mirrored users' mental models – they think in terms of "my team" first, then "what type of asset." It also ensured that a user from any team landing on the platform could immediately find their section without scanning through irrelevant content.

Low-Fidelity Wireframes

> **[VISUAL: Low-Fidelity Wireframes – Key Pages]** Grayscale wireframe layouts for:
>
> 1. **Home Page** – Grid of organization/team cards with clear labels
> 2. **Team Landing Page** – Asset category cards with thumbnail previews
> 3. **Asset Category Page** – Grid of downloadable assets with metadata
> 4. **Navigation System** – Persistent sidebar/top nav showing hierarchy breadcrumbs

> Annotations with callouts explaining design decisions.

Wireframes focused on three critical elements:

1. **Global Navigation** – Persistent nav allowing users to jump between teams and categories from anywhere
2. **Team Landing Pages** – Clear visual display of available asset categories
3. **Asset Grids** – Scannable thumbnail grids with clear labels and one-click downloads

Design Iterations

> **[VISUAL: A/B Testing Variations]** Side-by-side wireframe comparisons showing tested variations:
> - **Test A:** Top navigation bar vs. **Test B:** Side navigation panel
> - **Test A:** Card grid view vs. **Test B:** List view
> - **Test A:** By asset type vs. **Test B:** By team → then type Winner indicators on the chosen option with brief rationale.

Multiple iterations were required to find the right balance between comprehensive navigation and simplicity. Early versions had too many navigation options; later iterations found the sweet spot where the structure was visible but not overwhelming.

UI Design & Prototyping

Visual Design Principles Applied

> **[VISUAL: Design Principles Applied]** Four principle tiles with visual examples:
> - **Hierarchy** – Typography scale example from the actual UI
> - **Scannability** – Card grid showing how eyes move (F-pattern overlay)
> - **Consistency** – Repeated component pattern across different team pages
> - **Accessibility** – Color contrast checks, readable text sizes

Typography: Consistent heading hierarchy to establish clear section boundaries. Team names prominent, asset categories secondary, descriptions tertiary.

Colors: Utilized Amazon's internal design language with strategic color coding for different asset categories, making visual scanning faster.

Layout: Card-based layout for asset display, providing visual previews alongside metadata. Grid system ensured consistency across all team pages while allowing each section to feel distinct.

High-Fidelity Designs

> **[VISUAL: High-Fidelity UI Screens – Full Resolution]** 5-6 polished mockups on device frames:
> 1. **Caboodle Home Page** – Organization grid with team entry points
> 2. **Team Page (e.g., CS Experience)** – Asset categories displayed as visual cards
> 3. **Asset Category View** – Thumbnail grid with download buttons, metadata
> 4. **Individual Asset Detail** – Preview + download options + version info
> 5. **Navigation State** – Showing breadcrumbs and persistent nav
> 6. **Search Results Page** – Filtered results with facets
>
> Present on laptop/desktop mockup frames for portfolio polish.

The final UI design emphasized:

- **Persistent navigation** – Always visible, always accessible, always contextual
- **Visual asset previews** – Users could see what they were downloading before clicking
- **Clear categorization labels** – No ambiguity about what lives where
- **Download CTAs** – Prominent, immediate, one-click

Interactive Prototypes

> **[VISUAL: Prototype Walkthrough — GIF/Video]** Animated prototype showing: Home → Click "CS Experience Team" → See asset categories → Click "Email Templates" → Browse thumbnails → Download asset Include Figma prototype link for interactive access.

Figma prototypes simulated the complete journey from home page through specific team sections to individual asset downloads. These were used for both stakeholder review and A/B testing sessions.

Usability Testing & Iterations

Usability Testing Approach

> **[VISUAL: Iterative Testing Process Diagram]** Circular/spiral diagram showing the iterative loop: Design → Prototype → Test → Analyze → Refine → (repeat) With "A/B Testing" highlighted at the testing stage. Note: "Continuous testing, not end-of-project testing"

I employed an **iterative A/B testing methodology** throughout the design process. Rather than designing in isolation and testing at the end, we tested continuously — validating assumptions at each stage and refining based on real user behavior.

Testing participants included the same Team Managers and Operations Managers from our initial research, ensuring continuity between identified problems and validated solutions.

A/B Testing

> **[VISUAL: A/B Test Results]** Test result cards showing:
> - **Test 1:** Navigation Type → Winner: Hybrid (side + top)
> - **Test 2:** Page Layout → Winner: Card grid view
> - **Test 3:** Organization Model → Winner: Team-first hierarchy Each with vote percentages or preference indicators.

Key A/B tests included:

- Navigation placement and structure (top nav vs. side nav vs. hybrid)
- Team page layouts (card grid vs. list view vs. categorized sections)
- Asset organization models (by type vs. by recency vs. by popularity)

Feedback & Insights

> **[VISUAL: Usability Testing Quotes]** Quote wall with user testimonials:
> - "I found my team's templates in seconds — this is amazing"
> - "The navigation makes sense immediately"
> - "I didn't need any explanation — it just works" Each on a styled card with user role indicated.

Testing revealed:

- Users overwhelmingly preferred the team-first navigation model
- Visual previews were critical — users wanted to see assets before downloading
- The new navigation eliminated the "lost" feeling entirely
- New users (unfamiliar with the platform) could find assets just as quickly as experienced users — validating the IA

Design Refinements

Based on testing:

- Adding "Recently Added" sections for users who check back frequently
- Implementing breadcrumb navigation for deeper pages
- Adding asset metadata (dimensions, file type, last updated) visible without clicking into detail pages

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Development Handoff

Design System & Components

> **[VISUAL: Component Library — Organized Grid]** Figma component library screenshot showing organized components:
> - **Navigation:** Header, Sidebar, Breadcrumbs
> - **Cards:** Team card, Category card, Asset preview card
> - **Buttons:** Download, Browse, Back
> - **Grids:** 2-col, 3-col, 4-col responsive layouts
> - **States:** Default, Hover, Active, Loading All labeled with variant names.

I built a reusable component library for Caboodle including:

- Navigation components (header, sidebar, breadcrumbs)
- Card components (asset preview cards, category cards, team cards)
- Grid layouts (responsive, adapting to content volume)
- Download interaction patterns
- Search and filter components

Developer Collaboration

> **[VISUAL: Dev Handoff Specs — Annotated Screen]** Annotated UI screen showing:
> - Spacing measurements (px values with dimension lines)
> - Color tokens (#hex values)
> - Typography specs (font, weight, size, line-height)
> - Component behavior notes
> - Responsive breakpoint indicators

Close collaboration with developers ensured the platform could handle the volume of assets and teams. Key technical discussions included:

- Backend integration with WorkDocs for asset storage
- Performance optimization for asset thumbnail loading
- Scalable architecture for adding new teams without redesign

Handoff Tools

All deliverables were provided through **Figma** with comprehensive documentation including component specs, interaction patterns, responsive breakpoints, and edge cases.

Impact & Results

Metrics & KPIs Achieved

> **[VISUAL: Impact Metrics — Large Number Display]**
>
> ```
> ┌─────────────────┐ ┌─────────────────┐ ┌─────────────────┐
>    │  +70%    │ │  36% → 81%  │ │  800 → 5,200  │
>    │ Adoption  │ │ Download  │ │  Unique  │
>    │  Rate   │ │ Rate   │ │ Users  │
>    └─────────────────┘ └─────────────────┘ └─────────────────┘
> ```
>
> Bold, colored numbers with trend arrows. Supporting context below each. Add a small line chart showing growth trajectory over time.

The redesigned Caboodle platform delivered transformative results:

- **70% increase in platform adoption** compared to the previous version
- **Template download rates increased from 36% to 81%** — more than doubling engagement
- **Total unique users grew from 800 to 5,200** — a 550% increase in user base
- **Reduced design support tickets** — teams could self-serve for standard asset needs

Before & After Comparisons

> **[VISUAL: Before & After — Platform Screenshots]** Two-panel dramatic comparison:

LEFT — Before:

- Screenshot of old platform (or recreation) showing: No navigation, flat file dump, no categories, confusing layout
- Red X markers on pain points
- Label: "No IA, No Nav, No Organization"

RIGHT — After:

- Screenshot of redesigned Caboodle showing: Clear navigation, team-based hierarchy, visual cards, download buttons
- Green checkmark markers on improvements
- Label: "Team-First IA, Persistent Nav, Self-Service"

[VISUAL: Growth Chart] Line or bar chart showing user growth over time:

- X-axis: Months since launch
- Y-axis: Unique users
- Line showing growth from 800 to 5,200
- Annotation markers for key milestones (nav added, teams onboarded, etc.)

Metric	Before Redesign	After Redesign
Platform Adoption Rate	Baseline	+70%
Template Download Rate	36%	81%
Total Unique Users	800	5,200
Navigation Availability	None	Full persistent navigation
Asset Organization	Scattered folders	Team-based IA hierarchy
Self-Service Capability	Minimal (ticket-based)	Full self-service

Business/User Outcomes

Business: Dramatically reduced design team's support burden created a scalable distribution system and established a single source of truth that ensures brand consistency across all CS teams.

Users: Empowered teams to find and use design assets independently, reduced time-to-asset from days (ticket wait) to seconds (self-service), and increased confidence that they were always using the latest, approved versions.

Lessons Learned & Challenges

Key Takeaways

[VISUAL: Key Lessons — Illustrated Cards] Four cards with custom illustrations:

- Scale research to match user base (100-150 participants)
- Information Architecture IS the product
- Team-based mental models are powerful
- Iterative A/B testing prevents costly mistakes

1. **Scale your research to match your user base** — Interviewing 100-150 stakeholders was intensive but essential for a platform serving thousands
2. **Information architecture IS the product** — For an asset management platform, the IA redesign delivered more impact than any visual design change could have

3. **Team-based mental models are powerful** — Organizing content around how users think about their work (their team) rather than how the design team thinks about assets (by type) was transformative
4. **Iterative A/B testing prevents costly mistakes** — Continuous testing kept us on track without major late-stage redesigns

What Worked Well

- The team-first IA hierarchy perfectly matched user mental models
- A/B testing methodology caught issues early and cheaply
- Large research sample provided confidence in decisions
- Navigation addition was the single highest-impact design change

What Didn't / Future Improvements

- Initial rollout needed more onboarding for users accustomed to the old folder system
- Search functionality could be enhanced with AI-powered recommendations
- Version control visibility could be more prominent
- Analytics dashboard for the design team to track which assets are most/least used

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Conclusion & Final Thoughts

Summary

> **[VISUAL: Project Impact Summary — Infographic Strip]** Horizontal infographic summarizing the entire project: Old State (chaos) → Research (100-150 users) → Redesign (team-first IA) → Result (5,200 users, 81% downloads) With connecting arrows. Clean, minimal style.

Caboodle's transformation from a neglected, unstructured asset repository to a thriving, centralized design platform demonstrates the power of user-centered information architecture. By conducting extensive research with 100-150 stakeholders, implementing a team-first navigation hierarchy, and iterating through A/B testing, we achieved a 550% growth in unique users and more than doubled template download rates.

This project reinforced that UX design isn't always about creating something visually revolutionary — sometimes the most impactful design work is creating structure where chaos existed, building navigation where there was none, and organizing content around how users actually think rather than how systems store data.

Next Steps & Future Considerations

> **[VISUAL: Future Roadmap — Timeline]** Horizontal roadmap with upcoming initiatives:
> - Q1: Intelligent search + filters
> - Q2: Usage analytics dashboard
> - Q3: Personalized recommendations
> - Q4: Figma plugin integration

- Implement intelligent search with filters (by team, asset type, date added)
- Add usage analytics for the design team to inform future asset creation priorities
- Explore personalized recommendations ("Assets your team uses most")
- Integrate with design tools (Figma plugin for direct asset import)
- Build version history and change notification system

> **[VISUAL: Case Study Footer]** "Designed by Pradeep | Sr. Visual Designer" + Portfolio links + "Thank you for reading"